CHAPTER 14

THE BASE[1]

Preparing the ground[2]

1-4a For the building of houses of gods, brahmins and (other) classes there are two sorts of ground suitable, dry and moist.[3] 'Dry' terrain is well supplied with gravel, hard to dig and (when it is dug) rich in water clear as the moon. The terrain is 'moist' when the foundations, dug to the dimensions of the projected building,[4] reveal open blue lotuses and withered cucumbers along with white sand.

4b-8 After water has been reached the trench should be filled with bricks, earth and fine sand and packed tight so that there are no gaps,[5] then,

1. The base (*adhiṣṭhāna, māsuraka, tala* etc. see v. 40) is the first of the 'levels of elevation' (*varga*, infra note 9); cf. *Mānasāra* (chapter 14), *Ajita* (chapter 12, Dagens 1948, pp. 52-54 and Tables II/a and b), *Īśānaśiva* (Kriyā. 31.1-29), *Śilparatna* (17.1-14 and chapter 19). A list of types of base is given by N.R. Bhatt in his *Ajitāgama* edition (vol. 1 p. 91).
2. The beginning of the chapter does not deal directly with the base but with an examination of the site to be done according to a method slightly different from the one prescribed in chapters 3 and 4. According to *Śilparatna* (10.16) this examination must take place before the setting of the gnomon (see chapter 6).
3. In *Arthaśāstra jāṅgala* and *anūpa* designate two kinds of agricultural land differenciated by the quantity of rain they receive (II.24.5: *ṣoḍaśadroṇaṃ jāṅgalānāṃ varṣapramāṇam, adhyardham anūpānāṃ deśavāpānām* . . .; for other references see Kane vol. III, p. 132). According to *Śilparatna* (10.1-3) the two kinds of land suitable for construction are called *snigdha* and *asnigdha*:

   स्निग्धं चैव तथास्निग्धं द्विविधं भूमिलक्षणम् ।
   चिक्कणा शर्कराढ्या वाप्यशक्यखननक्रिया ॥
   या सा स्निग्धा मही ख्याता तनुवालुकसंयुता ।
   पुरुषाञ्जलिमात्रे तु दृष्टा तोयसमन्विता ॥
   अक्लेशात् खननं यत्र सा स्निग्धाख्या मही स्मृता ।
   हस्तमात्रं खनेत् स्निग्धभूवमन्यत् तथाजलम् ॥

4. *Kriyamāṇasya vastunaś ca balaṃ yathā*: "according to the strength of the intended buildings".
5. All this will serve as foundations for the building.

तत्खाते सलिलेनैव पूरितेऽक्षयता शुभा ।
[18]समत्वं सलिलेनैव साधयित्वा[19] विचक्षणः ॥ ६ ॥
गर्भं प्रक्षिप्य[20] तं नीत्या होमं[21] तत्र निधापयेत् ।
स्तम्भद्वित्रिगुणव्यासं[22] तदर्धं[23]बहलान्वितम् ॥ ७ ॥
उपानोपरि पद्मं चोपोपानं च[24] तदूर्ध्वतः ।
यथाशोभांशमानेन[25] कुर्यात् तत्र विचक्षणः ॥ ८ ॥

18. C : समं तु
19. D : सलिलं नैव स्वाधयित्वा
20. C : निक्षिप्य
21. A (var) : नित्योपानं; C : नित्योवने
22. C : व्यासात्
23. C : तदर्धं for तदर्ध-
24. D : न for च
25. E : शोभाङ्गमानेन

when this has been stamped down by the trampling of elephants as well as with large logs of hard wood,[6] the sage, after having filled up the (remaining) hollow with water which, (if the enterprise is) to be successful, it will retain, must verify the horizontality of the ground with this water.[7] Next the foundation deposit should be laid down according to rule and, lastly, the adjustment slab should be set in place;[8] this is two or three times as wide as a pillar and its thickness is half its width. Above this slab is a lotus and a secondary slab, the proportions of which are imposed upon the sage by the harmony.

6. Or "with huge logs shaped like elephant foot".
7. See 4.16 sq. and 6.3.
8. *Homa*: the emendation proposed in Trivandrum edition (*nityopānam* for *nityā homam*) does not seem necessary as *homa* appears elsewhere as a synonym of *upāna* (see 12.42: *homastambha* placed upon the foundation deposit). Such slabs form the adjustment layer placed just above the foundations and upon which will be established the base. While not being always clear, the *Śilparatna* (19.102-07a) gives some details on the subject:

यत्र प्रासादकरणं तले तत्र समीकृते ।
होमं विन्यस्य परितस्तत्तद्द्रव्यैर्यथोदितैः ॥
भित्तिपादस्य विष्कम्भं द्विगुणं त्रिगुणं तु वा ।
होमानीप्रमिति ख्यातं तद्बाहल्यं तदर्धतः ॥
मानसूत्राद् बहिर्नीप्रं द्वित्रिदण्डमथापि वा ।
होमानीप्रं पुनः प्रोक्तमुपपीठं गलात्तु वा ॥
अधिष्ठानजगत्या वा पादुकाद्वा विमानके ।
होमोर्ध्वेऽब्जे प्रकर्तव्ये तत्पीठाद्धोमनिष्क्रमः ॥
पद्मस्य वेशरस्योच्चं समं पादोनमेव वा ।
तदूर्ध्वे वापि चाद्यङ्गं होमोर्ध्वे वोपपीठकम् ॥
तदूर्ध्वेऽब्जमधिष्ठानं वा करोतु यथारुचि ॥

Our translation: "The ground is to be levelled at the place where the temple is to be built; then the *homā* is established with all the prescribed elements. The projection of the *homā* (outside the *mānasūtra*) [see 15.57] is two or three times the width of the pilasters (*bhittipāda*) and its thickness is half its width; otherwise the projection of the *homā* outside the *mānasūtra* is of two or three modules; otherwise, in the case of a temple, the projection of the *homā* is the same as the projection of the socle (*upapīṭha*) from the dado (*gala*) of the base or from its (main) plinth (*jagati*) or from its (secondary) plinth (*pāduka*). Then a doucine (*padma*) is to be established above the *homā* and the *homā* projection from the lower part of that doucine is equal to the height of the *padma veśara* (??) or less by a quarter. In order to obtain a beautiful effect, place the base (*ādyaṅga*, see *Mayamata* 14.40) above (the *homā*) or the socle above the *homā* or the doucine (*abja*) and the base above (the *homā*)."

उन्नतां प्रकृतिं[26] भूमिं कृत्वा हस्तप्रमाणतः ।
[27]घनीकृत्य तदूर्ध्वस्थमुपानं[28] जन्म चोच्यते ॥ ९ ॥
[29]तदूर्ध्वस्थमधिष्ठानं सोपपीठं[30] तु केवलम् ।
सस्तम्भं वा सकुड्यं वा जङ्घावर्गं तदूर्ध्वगम् ॥ १० ॥
[31]भूमिदेश इति ख्याता कपोतोर्ध्वगता प्रतिः[32] ।
प्रासादादीनि वास्तूनि चाधितिष्ठन्ति यद्धि तत्[33] ॥ ११ ॥

[अधिष्ठानोन्मानम्]

अधिष्ठानं तदुन्मानं[34] जाति[35] भूमिवशाद् द्विधा[36] ।
तैतिलानां चतुर्हस्तं त्रिहस्तार्धं द्विजन्मनाम् ॥ १२ ॥
नृपाणां त्रिकरं [37]सार्धद्विहस्तं यौवराजकम्[38] ।
[39]द्विहस्तं [40]वणिजामेकहस्तं शूद्रस्य कीर्त्यते[41] ॥ १३ ॥
एतज्जातिवशाद् भूमिवशादत्रैव कथ्यते ।
[42]दण्डात् षण्मात्रहान्या तु द्वादशाद्यात्[43] त्रिभूमिकम्[44] ॥ १४ ॥
[45]त्रितलस्योत्तमस्येष्टं पादेनोनं द्विहस्तकम् ।
[46]क्षुद्राणामनया[47] नीत्या विधातव्यं विचक्षणैः ॥ १५ ॥

26. D : प्रकृतं
27. D : omits 9b.
28. A (var) : -स्थ उपानं; C : तदुपानं
29. A (var) : तद्वदूर्ध्वम् for तदूर्ध्वस्थम्
30. D : चोपपीठं
31. D : omits 11a.
32. E : वृत्तिः for प्रतिः
33. E : यत् for तत्
34. F : तुतन्नाम for तदुन्मानं
35. C : यति for जाति
36. D : द्विधम्
37. C and D : सार्धं for सार्ध-
38. E : युवराजकम्
39. E : omits 13b.
40. D : वैश्यजाम्
41. A (var) : कीर्तितम्; D : कर्तयेत्
42. D : दण्डाचतुर्हस्तान्तु द्वादशान्यात् त्रिभूमिकान्
43. C : द्वादशाद्यान्
44. A, C, F : त्रिभूमिकात्
45. A (var), C, F : त्रितलस्योक्तमस्येष्टं
46. D : क्षुद्राणां धनादित्या विधातव्या विचक्षणाम्
47. C : चानया for अनया

9-11a The regulating course called 'origin' should be laid down after the original ground has been raised one cubit and has been rendered compact. Directly above this is the base unless there is a socle (beneath it); above the base is the (so-called) 'level of the pillars' which is made up of pillars or of a wall.[9] The height of (the ground) floor is the same as that of the stereobate[10] which is above the dripstone (of the base).

11b-16 The base is that upon which buildings such as temples rest. Its height may be determined in two ways, according to the number of the storeys (of the building) or to the caste. For the gods that height is four cubits, for brahmins it is three and a half cubits, for kings three cubits, for crown princes two and a half, for merchants two and, lastly, for śūdra, one cubit. Such are the heights of the base according to caste. Herewith these, (calculated) according to the number of storeys, starting with a height of one pole (i.e. four cubits) for the base of a building with twelve storeys and decreasing by six digits (for each storey less) down to buildings with three storeys, the largest of which have a base one and

9. *Jaṅghāvarga*: *varga* are horizontal divisions of the building; these levels of elevation get their names from the structural levels to which they correspond roughly; they are of six kinds: level of base, of the pillars, of the entablature, of the attic of the roof and of the finial (see Dagens 1984 pp. 49-50). The *Jaṅghāvarga* (*ibid.*, pp. 54 sq.; infra chapter 15) which corresponds to the 'inhabitable' portion of the building (or of a storey if the building is multistoreyed) is most of the time designated as 'pillar' (*stambha, pāda, jaṅghā* . . .) even if it does not comprise any pillar or pilaster.

10. *Bhūmideśa*: *bhūmi* (*tala, bhū* etc.) designates a 'storey' (which comprises a 'level of pillars' and an entablature) (Dagens 1984 p. 50), the first storey standing upon the base. *Prati*: the term is ambiguous (as are its numerous synonyms: *vedī, vedikā, vitardi, vṛti, paṭṭikā*, etc.). It may be applied to a moulding (a string-course placed at the top of a mouldered ensemble, especially base and entablature) as well as to a supplementary level of elevation which we may call 'stereobate'. That last can be placed between the base and the level of pillars of the ground storey or between the entablature of a storey and the level of pillars of the storey which tops it (in that case it is sometimes called *antaraprastara* or *madhyamamañca*: 'intermediate entablature', cf. chapter 20 note 9) or between the entablature of the last storey and the attic. It is not always easy to know if a *prati* mentioned in relation with a base is the top moulding of that base or the stereobate placed above it. The stereobate plays an important role in the laying out of doors (see infra vv. 45-46).

[48]तत्तत्पादोदयार्धेन[49] षडष्टांशोनमानतः ।
अधिष्ठानस्य चोत्सेधं वास्तुवस्तुनि भूवशात् ॥ १६ ॥
[50]यदुपानस्य निष्क्रान्तं[51] तत् त्र्यंशेन विभाजयेत्[52] ।
[53]त्यक्त्वैकांशं बहिस्तत्र[54] जगतीं कारयेद् बुधः ॥ १७ ॥
[55]तद्वत् कुमुदपट्टं[56] च तद्वत् कण्ठस्य[57] वेशनम् ।
[58]आत्तोत्सेधांशमानं तु भागमानेन वक्ष्यते ॥ १८ ॥

[पादबन्धम्]

अष्टसप्तशशिबन्ध[59]भागिक[60]श्चन्द्रबन्ध[61]शशिभागिकैः क्रमात् ।
[62]वप्रकं कुमुदकम्प[63]कन्धरं कम्पवाजनमधोर्ध्वकम्पकम्[64] ॥ १९ ॥
पादबन्धमुदितं तदुच्छ्रये
[65]भानुभिर्द्विगुणितांशके[66] कृते ।
देवविप्रनृपवैश्यशूद्रके-
ष्वेवमुक्तमृषिभिः पुरातनैः ॥ २० ॥

48. F : omits 16-18a; A (var), B (var), D, E and F add after 15b : मसूरकोन्नतं पञ्चहस्ते द्वात्रिंशदङ्गुलम्। त्रिंशदङ्गुलमूलं वा द्विद्व्यङ्गुलविवर्धनात्॥ अष्टौत्रिंशतिमात्रोच्चं त्रयोदशविशालिनः । षडादीनां तु पञ्चानामेकत्रिंशतिमात्रकः ॥ नवत्रिंशतिमात्रोच्चं चतुर्दशकरस्य तु । त्रिचतुर्हस्तयोर्धाग्रोस्तत्रीत्यैव विचक्षणः । आत्तोत्सेधांशमानेन वाधिष्ठानोच्छ्रयं विदुः ॥ कैश्चित् तेन प्रकारेण विधातव्यं विचक्षणैः ।
49. D : तत्तत्पादार्द्धयार्धेन
50. D : तद् for यद्
51. E : निष्टातं
52. A (var) : तत्र त्र्यंशेन भाजयेत्
53. D : एकैकांशं for त्यक्त्वैकांशं
54. D : तस्य instead of तत्र
55. D : तत्तद् ; E : यद्वत्
56. C : -पादं instead of पट्टं
57. D : कर्णञ्च
58. D : adds : अग्रपट्टस्य विस्तारात् कपोतकं तु वेशनम् ।
59. D : वह्नि for बन्ध
60. A : भागकैश्च-
61. D : वह्नि for बन्ध
62. A (var), C : वक्त्रकं
63. C : कुमुदकं च for कुमुदकम्प-
64. D : कम्पपट्टिकस्योर्ध्वं तु कम्पकम्
65. D : भानुभू-
66. C : गुणिकांशके

three quarter cubits high. Another method of calculating the height of the base is indicated by the sages for smaller buildings: this height should be equal to half that of the corresponding pillar less a sixth or an eighth. Such is the height of the base calculated according to the number of the storeys of the building.

17-18a The sage will make the projection of the plinth (of the base) one-third less than the projection of the regulating course;[11] the projection of the torus and the string-course and the recess of the dado are equal (to the projection of the plinth).

18b The number of parts into which the given height (of a base) should be divided and how they should be distributed is now indicated.

Pādabandha base

19-20 The height (of the base) is divided into twenty-four parts: the plinth[12] takes up eight parts, the torus seven, a fillet one, the dado three,[13] a fillet one, the upper string-course three and its two flanking fillets one. Such is the *pādabandha* base which is prescribed by the sages for buildings intended for gods, brahmins, kings, vaiśya and śūdra.[14]

11. *Upāna*: see above note 8.
12. *Vapra* designates a wall or a glacis; its use here is probably justified by the plinth being vertical as a wall.
13. *Bandha* for according to Sāṅkhya there are three mundane bondages (*prakṛtibandha*, *vaikārika*⁰ and *dakṣiṇā*⁰).
14. Thus such a base my be used for any building; see also infra vv. 45-46 where it is told that the *pādabandha* base may be interrupted by a door, which explains that it is prescribed for gateways (24.28).

[उरगबन्धम्]

[67]चन्द्रदृक्शशिशिवांशकै रसैर्धातुभिश्च[68] समभागिकैः क्रमात् ।
वाजनं प्रतिमुखं त्रियश्रकं दृक् च वृत्तकुमुदं[69] तु वप्रकम् ॥ २१ ॥
त्रिःषडंशसमभागिके तले नागवक्त्रसदृशं प्रतिद्वयम्[70] ।
देवविप्रनृपमन्दिरेषु तद्योग्यकं ह्युरगबन्धकं[71] भवेत् ॥ २२ ॥

[प्रतिक्रमम्]

अंशाध्यर्धार्धभागैर्मुनिरसशशिभिश्चन्द्रदृक्च्छैवभागैः[72]
क्षुद्रोपानाब्जकम्पं जगतिकुमुदकं धारया युक्तमूर्ध्वे ।
आलिङ्गान्तादिकं तत्प्रतिमुखमथ तद्वाजनं पद्मयुक्तं
त्रिःसप्तांशे तलोच्चे[73] करिहरि[74]मकर[75]व्यालरूपादि भूष्यम् ॥ २३ ॥

प्रतिक्रमं तत् सुरमन्दिरोचितं[76]
विचित्रितं पत्रलतादिरूपकैः ।
द्विजन्मभूमीश्वरयोर्मतं गृहे
[77]शुभप्रभं पुष्टिकरं जयावहम् ॥ २४ ॥

[पद्मकेसरम्]

[78]एकद्व्येकेन षड्भिः शशिशिवशशिभिर्वेद[79]चन्द्रैकभागै-
र्द्व्यंशैकेनांशनेत्रैः शिवशशिसमभागेन[80] जन्माब्जकं च ।
[81]वप्रं पद्मं गलाब्जं कुमुदमुपरि पद्मं च कम्पं गलं तत्
कम्पं पद्मं च पट्टीकमलमुपरिकम्पं[82] च षड्विंशदंशे[83] ॥ २५ ॥

67. D : चन्द्रयुग्मशशिव्योमदंशके
68. E : चतुर्भिः; F : वाजिभिः
69. D : गलकुमुदं
70. D : हि कद्वयम्
71. C, D : ह्युरकवन्धकं; F : ह्युरगवन्धनं
72. E : चैवभागैः
73. E : तथोच्चे
74. C : हय for हरि
75. D : मकरैर् for मकर-
76. F : सुरमन्दिशोभितं
77. A, B, C, E, F : इभप्रभं
78. C : एकद्वैकोन
79. A, C, D, E, F : बन्ध- for वेद-
80. A, B, C, E, F : भागोन
81. C : वक्त्रं
82. A (var) : तम्पं
83. D : अंशैः

Uragabandha base[15]

21-22 (The height of the base) is divided into eighteen equal parts: the top-fillet takes up one part, the upper string-course two, a champfered fillet one, a talon (?) three, the well rounded torus six and the plinth five. This is an *uragabandha* base which, furnished as it is with two string-courses, resembles a serpent's mouth (?); it is suitable for the palaces of gods, brahmins and kings.

Pratikrama base

23-24 The height of the base is divided into twenty-one (equal) parts: the small plinth[16] takes up one part, a doucine one and a half and a fillet one half; the main plinth takes up seven parts, the torus six, its talon one, and two flanking fillets one each; the upper string-course takes up two parts and its fillet, decorated with lotuses, one. Such a base, decorated with images, elephants, *makara, vyāla* (. . . etc.), is called *pratikrama* and is appropriate for temples and, when decorated with foliage and creepers, is suitable for the houses of brahmins and kings, bringing happiness, prosperity and victory.

Padmakesara base

25-26 (The height of the base) is divided into twenty-six (equal) parts: the (first) plinth takes up one part, a doucine two, a (second) plinth one, a (second) doucine six, a groove one, a (third) doucine one, a reed one, a (fourth) doucine four, a fillet one and a groove one; a string-course takes up two parts, a (fifth) doucine one, the upper string-course two, a

15. The *uragabandha* base is described starting from the top and not from its lower mouldings as it is the case for other bases. Cf. *Mānasāra* (14.40-41).

16. *Kṣudropāna*: the base described here (the following ones as well) is of a two register type and its lower register comprises a small plinth and a doucine (for similar types described in *Ajitāgama*, see Dagens 1984 Tables II/1 and 2).

पद्मकेसरमेतदुदाहृतं कम्पवाजनपङ्कजकैर्युतम्[84] ।
कुम्भवप्रयुतं च सकन्धरं[85] शम्भुधामनि तत् प्रविधीयते[86] ॥ २६ ॥

[पुष्पपुष्कलम्]

भागेष्वेकार्धकार्धैस्तदुपरि चतुरंशैस्तथार्धांशकार्धै-
द्व्यर्धांशार्धद्विभागैस्तदुपरि च तथार्धांशकार्धेन जन्मम् ।
[87]वप्रं कञ्जं गलाब्जं तदुपरि कुमुदं पङ्कजं कम्पकण्ठं
कम्पं पद्मं महावाजनमुपरिदलं कम्पकं पङ्कजाढ्यम्[88] ॥ २७ ॥
पुष्पपुष्कलमेतदुदाहृतं कल्पितं नवपङ्क्तिभिरुच्छ्रये । ।
[89]शिल्पिभिः प्रसरैरपि[90] पूजितामूर्ध्वमध्यममुखे विमानके ॥ २८ ॥

[श्रीबन्धम्]

द्वाभ्यामेकेन सप्तांशकशशिशिव[91]वेदैकचन्द्राग्निभागै-
रेकेनैकेन वेदैः शिवशशिनयनैकेन मोहामराब्जम्[92] ।
हृत्पद्मं कैरवाब्जं[93] गलधरगलकम्पं दलं तत्कपोतं
[94]चालिङ्गान्तादिकं तत्प्रतिमुखमथ तद्वाजनं पङ्कजाढ्यम् ॥ २९ ॥
[95]श्रीबन्धं स्यादेतदुच्चे चतुर्वस्वंशे कुर्याच्छान्तधीर्वर्धकिस्तत्[96] ।
[97]देवेशानां मन्दिरेष्वेवमुक्तं श्रीसौभाग्यारोग्यभोग्यं ददाति ॥ ३० ॥

84. D : युक्तम्
85. D : सकस्वरं; E : सकुबरं
86. C : हि तद् विधीयते
87. E : वप्रं चाब्जं गलाब्जं
88. E : A, B, C, E, F : कण्ठजाढ्यम्
89. D : शिल्पविप्रवरैरस पूजितं स्थल्यमध्यममुख्यविमानकैः ।
90. A : प्रसरेरपि; C : प्रवरकैश्च
91. A (var) : शशिव- instead of शशिशिव-
92. E : जन्मं पुराब्जम्
93. C : केवलाब्जं
94. A, B, F : द्विलिङ्गान्तादिकं; E : मालिङ्गान्तादिकं
95. E : श्रृवलं
96. D : कुर्याच्छायतीथिर्वर्धकीस्तत्
97. E : देवादीनां

(sixth) doucine one and the top fillet one. Such is the *padmakesara* base which is furnished with fillets, string-courses and doucines as well as with torus, plinth and grooves; it is prescribed for the temple of Śambhu.[17]

Puṣpapuṣkala base

27-28 The height of the base is divided into nineteen parts: the (small) plinth takes up one part, the main plinth five, a doucine one, a groove one-half, half, a doucine one half, the torus which comes next four; then, a doucine takes up half a part, a fillet one-half, a small dado two, a fillet one-half, a doucine one-half, a string-course two and the row of leaves which surmounts it one-half and, lastly, the top-fillet takes up half a part. Such a base, furnished with several doucines, is called *puṣpapuṣkala* and is prescribed by the foremost amongst the artisans for medium and large temples.

Śrībandha base

29-30 The height (of the base) is divided into thirty-two parts: the (small) plinth[18] takes up two parts, a doucine one, the main plinth seven, a (second) doucine one, a third (doucine) one, a (fourth) doucine four, a groove one, a talon one, a dado three, a fillet one, a row of leaves one, the dripstone four and each of the two fillets which flank it one; the upper string-course takes up two parts and the top-fillet one. This base, furnished with several doucines, is called *śrībandha*. It must be established by an able *vardhaki*[19] is suitable for the palaces of gods and kings and brings good health and prosperity.

17. The *Mānasāra* (14.7-91) describes several *padmakesara* bases which are all characterized by the same thin mouldings and numerous doucines found here.
18. *Mohāmara*: literally 'the immortality of suffering', that is to say the 'birth' which leads us to the 'plinth' often called *janman*...
19. *Vardhaki*: see 5.22.

[मञ्चबन्धम्]

तुङ्गे षड्विंशदंशे खुरमथ[98] जगतीकैरवं कम्पकण्ठं
कम्पं पद्मं कपोतं तदुपरि च तथा निम्नमन्तादिवक्त्रम् ।
कम्पं भागेन षड्भिः शरशशिगुणचन्द्रैकबन्धांशकांशै-
र्द्वाभ्यामेकेन कुर्यादमरनरपतेर्मन्दिरे मञ्चबन्धम् ॥ ३१ ॥

[श्रीकान्तम्]

आलिङ्गयुक्तमथ चान्तरितप्रतीभ्यां[99]
तद्वाजनेन च वियुक्तकमेतदेव[100] ।
श्रीकान्तनामकमसूरकमष्टकोणं
वृत्तं तु वा कुमुदमम्बरमार्गिणां तत् ॥ ३२ ॥

[श्रेणीबन्धम्]

एकद्व्येकर्तुवेदैः[101] शशिनयनशिवद्व्येकदृक्चन्द्रसार्धा-
र्धांशैर्जन्माब्जकम्पं जगतिकुमुदकं कम्पकण्ठं[102] च कम्पम् ।
पद्मं पट्टं च कण्ठं तदुपरि च तथा वाजनाब्जं च पट्टं[103]
[104]श्रेणीबन्धं सुराणामुदितमिदमलं तुङ्गषड्विंशदंशे[105] ॥ ३३ ॥

[पद्मबन्धम्]

[106]सार्धार्धेष्वंशकांशैर्गुणशशिशिवचन्द्रद्विकैकेन[107] जन्म-
क्षुद्रं पद्मं धृगब्जं कुमुदमुपरि पद्मं[108] तथालिङ्गमूर्ध्वे ।
आलिङ्गान्तः प्रतिर्वाजनमथ मतिमान् योजयेत् त्रिःषडंशे
तुङ्गे देवेश्वराणामिदमुदितमगारेऽनघं[109] पद्मबन्धम् ॥ ३४ ॥

98. D : पुरमथ for खुरमथ
99. C : चान्तरितं प्रतीच्यां
100. A (var), C : कवियुक्तकमेतदेव
101. C : एकद्व्येकं तु वेदैः
102. E : कम्पकर्णं
103. E : पट्टि
104. D : श्रोणिबन्धं
105. D : अंशैः
106. D : सार्धार्धे पञ्चश्वंशांशौ गुणराशिचन्द्रद्विकैकेन
107. A (var), E : चैन्द्रद्विकैकेन
108. C : कम्पं instead of पद्मं
109. A (var), C, D : (अ)घनं for (अ)नघं

Mañcabandha base

31 The height of the base is divided into twenty-six equal parts: the false plinth[20] takes up one part and the main plinth six, a doucine above that takes up five parts, a fillet one, the dado three, another fillet one, a doucine one, the dripstone three and the groove topping it one and a fillet one; the upper string-course[21] and the two top-fillets take up one part. Such is the *mañcabandha* base which should be used for the palaces of gods and of kings.

Śrīkānta base

32 When the base is furnished with a projecting fillet together with a groove and an (upper) string-course (?) which has no top-fillet, it is called *śrīkānta*; its torus is octagonal or rounded and it is suitable for the denizens of the sky.[22]

Śreṇībandha base

33 The height of the base is divided into twenty-six (equal) parts: the small plinth takes up one part, a doucine two and a fillet one; the main plinth above that takes up six parts, the torus four, a fillet one, a groove two, a fillet one, a doucine two, a fillet one, a groove two, a fillet one, a doucine one and a half and the top fillet one. This *śreṇībandha* base is appropriate only for gods.

Padmabandha base

34 The height of the base is divided into eighteen (equal) parts: the plinth takes up one and a half parts, a small (fillet) one half, a doucine five, a talon one, a doucine three, a reed one, a doucine one and a fillet, above that, one. Then, a fillet which is below (the string-course) takes up one part, the upper string-course two and the top fillet one. Such is the *padmabandha* base which should be used by the sages for the houses of the principal gods[23] without there being any error.

20. *Khura*: 'hoof'.
21. *Vaktra*: 'the (decorated) face (of the moulding)' cf. *prativaktra* (13.20).
22. A less elliptical description is found in *Mānasāra* (15.350).
23. *Deveśvarāṇām*: or 'of the gods and the kings'.

[वप्रबन्धम्]

द्व्येकैकांशैः शरांशैर्युगशशिशिवदृक्[110] चन्द्रशैवाश्विनीभि-
भंगेनोपानकञ्जं[111] तदुपरि च तथा कम्पवप्रं च कुम्भम्[112] ।
पद्मं पट्टं च कण्ठं[113] तदुपरि च तथा कम्पपद्मं च पट्टी-
पट्टं तद्वप्रबन्धं तदपि च सहितं[114] सद्विकैर्विंशदंशैः ॥ ३५ ॥

[कपोतबन्धम्]

तदेव वृत्तं कुमुदं तु वाजने कपोतयुक्त हि कपोतबन्धकम् ।

[प्रतिबन्धम्]

तदेव वेदैः[115] प्रतिवाजनं प्रतिस्त्रिकाश्रयुक्तं प्रतिबन्धमुच्यते ॥ ३६ ॥

[कलशाधिष्ठानम्]

एकद्वयेकाग्नि[116] भागैः शशियुगलशिवद्व्येकचन्द्रेशदृग्भि-
श्चन्द्रैकैकाक्षिचन्द्रैः[117] खुरकमलमथो कम्पकण्ठं च कम्पम् ।
पद्मं पट्टाब्जनिम्नं कमलमुपरि कुम्भं दलं[118] निम्नमन्ताद्
या स्याच्चोर्ध्वे प्रतिर्वाजनमथ कलशाख्येन भागास्त्रिरष्टौ ॥ ३७ ॥

[अधिष्ठानसामान्यलक्षणम्]

एतानि भेदैस्तु[119] चतुर्दशैव प्रोक्तानि तज्ज्ञैस्तु मसूरकोणि ।
सर्वाणि नास्यङ्घ्रियुतानि युक्त्या[120]दृढीकृताङ्गानि मयोदितानि ॥ ३८ ॥

110. C : जन्मचवाश्विनीभिर्; D : चन्द्रचैकाश्विनीभिर्;
111. A (var) अब्जं for कञ्जं; E : कम्पे
112. A (var), C : कम्पवप्रत्यकुम्भम्
113. E : कम्पं for कण्ठं
114. D : समं instead of सहितं
115. D : वेदे
116. E : अब्धि for अग्नि
117. C : कांशैः
118. D : दल-; E : नत्वं
119. D, E : भेदेन
120. D : युक्ता

Vaprabandha base

35 (The height of the base) is divided into twenty-two equal parts: the small plinth takes up two parts, a doucine and the fillet which tops it one each. The main plinth takes up five parts, the torus four, a doucine one, a fillet one, a recessed strip two, a fillet one, a doucine one, the upper string-course two and the fillet which tops it one. Such is the *vaprabandha* base.

Kapotabandha base

36a When the torus is well rounded and when there is a dripstone at the top of the base it is a *kapotabandha* base.[24]

Pratibandha base

36b When the upper string-course and the top fillet together take up four parts and when the torus resembles a champfered string-course the base is called *pratibandha*.

Kalaśa base

37 (The height of the base) is divided into twenty-four (equal) parts: the plinth (*khura*) takes up one part, a doucine two, a fillet one, the dado three, another fillet one, a (second) doucine two, a (third) fillet one, a (third) doucine two, a groove one, a (fourth) doucine one, a reed two, a row of leaves one, a groove one and each of the fillets which flank it one; the upper string-course takes up two parts and the top fillet one. Such a base is called *kalaśa*.

Characteristics common to all bases

38-39 Such, with their characteristics, are the fourteen varieties of base prescribed by the sages. If expedient, any one of them may be provided with small pillars and false dormer-windows[25] and the elements which I have indicated may be reinforced. In order to make the base more solid the wise man should add or subtract (to the proportions indicated) one part or half, three quarters or one quarter of a part, or (he should add or

24. See *Ajita* 13.6-7 (Dagens 1984 Table II/1).
25. Small pillars must be on dado, and dormer-windows (so called *kuḍu*) on dripstone.

भागेनार्धत्रिपादाङ्घ्रिभिरथ युगलाध्यर्धचन्द्रार्धपादै-
मत्रैर्वृद्धिश्च हानिर्दृढतरमतिना योजितव्या बलार्थम् ।
शोभार्थं भागमङ्गप्रतिवरसमनीचाल्पहर्म्ये तलाना-
मेवं प्रोक्तं [121]यमीन्द्रैरविकलमतिभिस्तन्त्रविद्भिः पुराणैः ॥ ३९ ॥

[अधिष्ठानपर्यायनामानि]

मसूरकमधिष्ठानं वस्त्वाधारं धरातलम् ।
तलं कुट्टिममाद्यङ्गं पर्यायवचनानि हि ॥ ४० ॥

[निर्गममानम्]

यावज्जगतिनिष्क्रान्तं तावत् कुमुदनिर्गमम् ।
अम्बुजानां तु सर्वेषामुत्सेध[122]समनिर्गमम् ॥ ४१ ॥
[123]दलाग्रतीव्रमुत्सेधात्[124] पादं पादार्धमेव वा ।
वेत्राणामपि[125] सर्वेषां चतुर्भागैकनिर्गमम्[126] ॥ ४२ ॥
तत्समं वा त्रिपादं वा महावाजननिर्गमम् ।
एवं तीव्रक्रमं[127] प्रोक्तं शोभाबलवशात् तु वा[128] ॥ ४३ ॥
प्रवेशनिर्गमं कुर्यात् सर्वाङ्गानां मसूरके ।

[अधिष्ठानप्रतिच्छेदविधिः]

प्रतिच्छेदं न कर्तव्यं सर्वत्रैवं विचक्षणैः ॥ ४४ ॥
[129]द्वारार्थं यत् प्रतिच्छेदं सम्पद्द्वारं च नेत्यलम्[130] ।

121. E : मुनीन्द्रैर्
122. D : उत्सेधं
123. E : omits 42a.
124. D : दनाग्रनीव्रमुत्सेधं
125. D : चैव for अपि
126. D : उच्छ्रये पादनिर्गमम्
127. D : नीव्रक्रमं; E : निम्नकमं; F : निर्गमं
128. D : यत् instead of वा
129. D : द्वारार्थवत्
130. D : सम्पदानां च नेत्यहम्

subtract) two digits, one and a half digits or one-half or one quarter of a digit. If the whole is to be harmonious it is essential that the proportions of the base be related to those of the building, whether it is large, medium, small or very small; thus affirm the ancients who had mastered their passions, whose intelligence was unrivalled and who were well versed in the Tantra.

Synonyms

40 *Masūraka*, *adhiṣṭhāna*, *vastvādhāra*, *dharātala*, *tala*, *kuṭṭima* and *ādyaṅga* are synonyms (whose meaning is base).[26]

Dimensions of projections

41-44 The projection of the torus is as great as that of the plinth; that of doucines is always equal to their height; that of the top of the row of leaves is a quarter or an eighth of the row's height; that of the string-course is equal to its height or to three quarters of it. The projection and recess of all mouldings are to be calculated according to the rule which has been given above or according to the appearance and solidity sought.

26. *Tala* also designates a 'storey' and *kuṭṭima* a 'paved street' (cf. 9.38).

पादबन्धमधिष्ठानं छेदनीयं यथोचितम् ॥ ४५ ॥
जन्मादिपञ्चवर्गे[131] तु तत्तत्तुङ्गावसानके[132] ।

131. D : वर्गैः

132. D : वसानकैः

Rule for the interruption of the base and stereobate[27]

45-46 In no case should the sage interrupt the stereobate (which tops the base). If the stereobate is interrupted for the sake of establishing a door, the door will be inauspicious but, if necessary, the *pādabandha* base

27. See above note 10. The rules given here may apply not only to doors but also to windows (cf. 16.67) or even to gargoyles (cf. *Śilparatna* quoted below). They appear in several texts:
—*Śilparatna* (20.129-31):

द्वारार्थं वा स्थलार्थं वा जलमार्गार्थमेव वा ।
जन्मादिपञ्चवर्गेषु तत्तदङ्गावसानके ॥
छेदनं नैव दोषाय पादबन्धतलेऽखिले ।
प्रतेश्छेदं न कर्तव्यं प्रतिबन्धकुले कदाचन ॥
जन्मच्छेदं न कर्तव्यं यत्रकुत्रापि सर्वतः ।
विपदामास्पदं ह्येतत् तस्मात्तन्नैव कारयेत् ॥

—*Īśānaśiva* (Kriyā. 31.101b-02a, about the doors of upper storeys):

सर्वत्र प्रत्युपरि द्वारं कुर्याद् विचक्षणः ।
प्रतिच्छेदेन तु द्वारं न कुर्वीत कदाचन ॥

—*Suprabhedāgama* (Kriyā. 31.33b-34 and 36-37a):

द्वारभेदं तथा शृणु ।
वृतेरूर्ध्वोत्तरान्तं यद् द्वारोत्सेधमुच्यते ।...
पद्मबन्धाद्यधिष्ठाने वृतेरुपरि निर्गमम् ॥
*वृतेरधस्तादुच्छेदं मसूरे पादबन्धके ।
अङ्गच्छेदं तु कर्तव्यमाङ्गं तु न कारयेत् ॥
(* *vṛti* = *prati*, see below 16.1).

—*Ajita* (12.37 and 44a):

द्वारोत्सेधमथोच्यते ।
प्रतेरुत्तरसीमान्तं द्वारोत्सेधं विधीयते ॥
प्रतिच्छेदविधानेन द्वारं *नैव प्रकल्पयेत् ।
(* text *caiva* is a printing mistake).

On a more practical point the rule seems to be followed at least on some monuments. J. Harle observes that the door of the entrance pavilion of Shore Temple at Mahabalipuram is above the base and that the same things may be seen on several Pallava monuments (e.g. Matangesvara or Mukteśvara temples at Kāñcīpuram) and he adds "the Pallava appear to have been reluctant to interrupt the mouldings of the base in order to accommodate steps" (*Temple gateways of South India*, 1963, p.12). Similar observation has been made in Cambodia: thus B.P. Groslier when restoring Prasat Bay Kaek, a small brick temple at Angkor, has observed that the stairway was just built against the mouldings of the base without them being interrupted; the steps placed in front of the false-doors on the upper storey of Prasat O Paong (Phnom Kulen) are placed similarly against the stereobate.

[133]सपट्टिकाङ्गेऽधिष्ठानेऽप्यन्यस्मिन्नेवमूह्यताम् ॥ ४५ ॥
यद् यत्रैवोचितं प्राज्ञस्तत् तत्रैव प्रयोजयेत् ॥ ४६$\frac{१}{२}$ ॥
[134]स्तम्भोच्चार्धं वा मसूरोच्चमानं
तत् षट्सप्ताष्टांशकं[135] भागहीनम् ।
वस्त्वाधारोच्चं भवेत् सर्ववस्तु-
ष्वेवं पूर्वं शम्भुना सम्यगुक्तम् ॥ ४७$\frac{१}{२}$ ॥

इति मयमते वस्तुशास्त्रे अधिष्ठानविधानो नाम
चतुर्दशोऽध्यायः

133. D : पट्टिकाङ्गेऽधिष्ठानेऽप्यन्तस्तस्मिन्नेवमूह्यताम्
134. E : शम्बच्चे
135. D : आंशतो

may be interrupted above any one of its five (main) mouldings from the plinth onwards.[28] This is not to be done however on a base comprising a stereobate.[29]

46 1/2 The wise man will place where prescribed that which is prescribed.

47 The height of the base is half that of the pillars or it is equal to half, less a sixth, seventh or eighth. Such is to be the height of the base for all types of buildings; it is precisely this that was prescribed by Śambhu in ancient times.

Thus ends, in the *Mayamata* treatise on dwelling,
the fourteenth chapter: RULES FOR BASES.

28. Cf. *Śilparatna* quoted in previous note. This means probably that in case a door interrupts a *pādabandha* base this must not happen in the middle of the height of one of the main mouldings (and in any case the plinth is not to be interruped, cf. *Śilparatna* 20.131). At present time *pañcavarga* is a normal designation of the base in Kerala, the five *varga* being the main mouldings of the more common type of base in this area: *pādukā* (first plinth), *jagatī* (main plinth), *kumuda* (torus), *gala* (groove or dado according to the size) and *prati* (upper string-course).

29. *Paṭṭikāṅga* = *prati*.